

PIETRO ROMEO

UX & Product Development | MSc Human-Computer Interaction

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WORK EXPERIENCE

Freelance Web Developer & Product Owner

Self-Employed (Partita IVA: 03173170808)

 May 2021 – Present  Remote

Managing a portfolio of digital products with a focus on full-stack development and UX strategy.

- **Product Ownership:** Oversee full lifecycle of niche web apps and digital assets, from UX research to technical deployment and maintenance.
- **Technical Stack:** Architect responsive properties using **Astro**, **Cloudflare**, and **JS**, optimizing for high-performance SEO and global reach.
- **Monetization:** Manage programmatic international revenue streams, including platform affiliate partnerships and automated digital advertising networks.
- **Data-Driven Research:** Utilize digital ethnography and behavior analytics (**Hotjar**) to identify market gaps and optimize conversion rates.

UX Researcher

FlixBus GmbH (FlixBus)

 Sep 2018 – Apr 2021  Berlin, DE

UX researcher for FlixBus and FlixTrain, acting as a consultant within the organisation.

- Fostered a culture of user-centricity across the organisation through a series of **bottom-up UX initiatives**.
- Supported 15+ teams **across tech and business** and trained stakeholders to conduct autonomous basic user research.
- Executed **moderated, unmoderated remote, and on-site field studies**, translating findings into actionable service design workshops.

Insights Specialist (Freelance)

UserTribe

 Jun 2018 – Apr 2019  Remote

Remote UX research projects for clients across international markets.

- Prepared material for **remote unmoderated interviews** and think-alouds, minimizing bias during script translation.
- **Analyzed and transcribed findings** from video recordings to prepare executive reports for stakeholders.

Student Assistant (HCI module)

University of Twente

 Nov 2016 – Feb 2017  Enschede, NL

- Tutored students on HCI assignments, covering literature reviews, **experimental design, and functional prototyping**.

ABOUT

MSc Human-Computer Interaction graduate and multi-disciplinary Product Owner. I combine deep UX research expertise with full-stack development to build and scale niche digital products and revenue-generating web assets.

COMPETENCES

Full-Stack Development

Product Management

UX Research

SEO Strategy

Service Design

Monetization

Innovation

TECH & METHODS

Astro

Cloudflare

JavaScript

HTML/CSS

Claude Code

Contextual Inquiry

Ethnography

Usability Testing

Affiliate Marketing

LANGUAGES

Italian (native) 

English (near-native) 

EDUCATION

M.Sc. Human-Computer Interaction & Design *

Technische Universität Berlin

 Oct 2017 – Oct 2018  Berlin, DE

M.Sc. Human-Computer Interaction & Design *

University of Twente

 Aug 2016 – Jul 2017  Enschede, NL

B.Sc. Software Engineering (Hons)

University of Glasgow

 Sep 2012 – Jun 2016  Glasgow, UK

* Double degree with EIT Digital, including a minor in Innovation and Entrepreneurship.

SELECTED PROJECTS

aitrainer.work – AI Evaluation Career Platform

 Dec 2025 – Present  Proprietary Product

Overview: A specialized, high-traffic career platform and intelligence hub built from scratch to serve the global AI evaluation and data annotation sector.

Technical Architecture: Architected and deployed the full-stack application using **Astro**, **Cloudflare**, and **JS**. Designed and maintained automated data pipelines to aggregate and structure complex role data from international platforms. Built a programmatic SEO framework to scale organic search visibility.

Commercial Model: Cited as an industry authority by major tech media (*The Next Web*). Fully monetized through automated B2B referral links and revenue-share partnerships, generating programmatic international commissions upon successful user placements.

Full-Stack Architecture Data Pipelines Programmatic SEO Cloudflare Workers Product Management

Why do customers in Southern Italy prefer to book offline?

 Jul-Aug 2019  FlixBus

Problem: Lower online booking rates in Southern Italy compared to national averages.

Methodology: Field research study combining contextual inquiry and ethnography to investigate user behavior at stations and agencies.

Outcome: Identified user requirements for online solutions to replace established offline purchase habits.

Field Study Contextual Inquiry Ethnography Cross-Cultural Studies

Testing Self Check-in with a Fake Bus in the office

 Dec 2018  FlixBus

Problem: Needed to validate a physical device before pilot launch on buses.

Methodology: Created an "experience prototype" to observe boarding behavior, followed by focus groups with users.

Outcome: Optimized UI and physical device placement based on passenger movement patterns.

Experience Prototyping Usability Testing Focus Group Offline Products

Helping Finnish retailer K-Rauta promote their services

 Aug 2017  EIT Digital Summer School

Problem: Low awareness of renovation services compared to retail products.

Methodology: Two-week Lean Service Creation workshop with concept validation via fake ads and MVP prototyping.

Outcome: Developed a loyalty programme that significantly increased service awareness and usage.

Service Design Lean Service Creation Innovation User Interviews Concept Testing

TALKS

BetterUX London 2019

- *Don't Guess it, Test It!* (N.d.). URL: <https://tinyurl.com/betteruxflix>.

ResearchOps Meetup Berlin #2

- *UX Maturity* (n.d.). URL: <https://tinyurl.com/researchopsflixbus>.

PUBLICATIONS

Conference Proceedings

- Poel, Mannes et al. (2018). "BrainSnake: Exploring Interaction in a Cooperative Multi-brain BCI Game Based on Alpha Activity". In: *The Eleventh International Conference on Advances in Computer-Human Interactions*, pp. 39–44.
- Rost, Mattias et al. (2016). "Forget-me-not: History-less mobile messaging". In: *Proceedings of the 2016 CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems*. ACM, pp. 1904–1908.
- Wilson, Graham, Pietro Romeo, and Stephen A Brewster (2016). "Mapping Abstract Visual Feedback to a Dimensional Model of Emotion". In: *Proceedings of the 2016 CHI Conference Extended Abstracts on Human Factors in Computing Systems*. ACM, pp. 1779–1787.

Working Papers

- Romeo, Pietro (2017). "Social behaviour of household robot-plant cyborgs: an explorative study".
- Karreman, Joyce, Pietro Romeo, and Qian Li (2016). "Cross-Cultural HCI and UX Design: A Comparison of Chinese and Western User Interfaces".